DIGITALAIKART
Premium AI digital products, made for India

INDIA EDITION · OCTOBER 2026

The AI Product Photo & Ad Creative Playbook

Turn one phone photo into a full catalogue of studio shots, festive banners and ad creatives.

A step-by-step playbook for Indian small sellers, D2C brands, boutique owners, creators and freelancers. Built on the tools that shipped in October 2026 — Google Nano Banana 2.1, OpenAI GPT Image 2.5 and Black Forest Labs FLUX 3 Image. Includes 100+ copy-paste prompts, exact marketplace image rules and a festive plan.

100+	7	₹3–₹12	40+
ready prompts	image jobs covered	per image	pages

Written and published by Digitalaikart · digitalkartai.shop
Every model name, price and platform rule in this edition verified from official sources, October 2026.

START HERE

About this playbook

In 2026 the single biggest thing stopping a small Indian seller from selling more is not price, packaging or ads. It is photographs. A studio shoot costs tens of thousands of rupees, so most small stores look the same — a product on a bedsheet, shot under a tube light. This playbook replaces that shoot with one clean phone photo and a few rupees of AI per image.

It is written for the person doing the work: the boutique owner in Jaipur, the home baker in Kochi, the D2C founder in Coimbatore, the Instagram reseller, the freelance designer. No design degree, no Photoshop, no studio. Just a phone, a window, and the exact prompts and rules inside this book.

Every model name, price and platform requirement here was checked against the provider's own page or the regulator's own guideline in October 2026. Where a rule can change, the book tells you to confirm it on the source before you rely on it.

The one rule that governs everything

AI drafts; you verify. Every image you publish must show the real product truthfully — same colour, same material, same size, same label. Keep at least one plainly real photo of each product. This is not just ethics: an image that oversells gets you returns, refunds and one-star reviews that cost far more than the photo saved.

How to use it. Read Chapters 1 and 2 once to understand the tools. Then live in Chapters 3 and 4 — the method and the prompt library — while you build your first image set. Keep Chapter 5 open when you upload to a marketplace, and use Chapter 6 as your festive-season calendar. Chapter 7 shows what it actually costs.

Disclaimer: this is an independent educational guide. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by or sponsored by Google, OpenAI, Black Forest Labs, Amazon, Flipkart, Meta or any other company named. Tool prices and platform rules change often — always confirm on the official source before you spend or publish.

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CHAPTER 1

Why visuals decide the sale in 2026

India's festive quarter is the biggest shopping window of the year, and it is running right now. Redseer forecasts that around 180–185 million Indians will shop online this festive season, with festive online sales growing about 25 per cent. In the first week of the Diwali sales, e-commerce order volumes rose 31 per cent year on year and quick-commerce orders jumped 85 per cent, with Tier-III towns alone accounting for 42 per cent of all orders.

That demand is won or lost on pictures. Google's own research on the 2026 festive shopper found that eight in ten Diwali and Navratri shopping journeys start with an idea taken from an image search or from images on social media, and that 53 per cent of festive shoppers use visual tools to discover or compare products. The product photo is not decoration. It is the first salesperson a shopper meets.

Why small sellers lose the visual race

A professional studio shoot in a metro city runs to tens of thousands of rupees a day, plus models, props and editing. A small seller cannot justify that per product, so the catalogue stays thin: one photo, often badly lit, often on a coloured background that a marketplace will suppress. The result is fewer clicks at the same price as a better-photographed competitor.

AI changed the economics of that problem in 2026. A single generated image now costs a few rupees rather than a few hundred, and the newest models can hold a product's shape, colour and label steady while changing everything around it — the surface, the light, the season, the setting. What used to be a studio booking is now an afternoon with a phone and a laptop.

But there is a catch, and it is the whole reason this book exists. AI makes it trivially easy to publish an image that does not match the product. A kurta that looks royal blue in the photo and arrives grey; a 'gold' bangle that is plated brass; a 'leather' bag that is PU. The shopper returns it, the marketplace penalises your account, and the review says 'not as shown'. So the playbook is built around one discipline: generate boldly, but verify against the real product every single time.

The opportunity in one line. Studio-quality visuals, at a few rupees an image, built from a phone photo — as long as you keep the product honest.

CHAPTER 2

The 2026 AI image toolbox

Three model releases in the first half of October 2026 changed what a one-person shop can do. Below is what each one is, what it costs, and the job it is best at. Prices are the providers' own list prices in October 2026, converted at roughly ₹90 to the US dollar; they change often, so confirm before you budget.

Google Nano Banana 2.1 — the workhorse

Released 6 October 2026, Nano Banana 2.1 is Google's fast, high-efficiency image generation and editing model (model id **gemini-nano-banana-2.1**). It generates and edits at 1K, 2K and 4K, accepts up to 14 reference images in a single edit, and can hold up to four characters and ten objects consistent across a conversation. Google cut the price roughly in half versus the previous version: about ₹3 per 1K image, ₹4.50 per 2K image and about ₹10 per 4K image on the paid API.

This is the model to reach for when you need volume — lifestyle variations of one product, seasonal backgrounds, ten versions of an ad to test. It is available in the Gemini app, Google AI Studio, Google Flow and Google Ads. One practical note: the previous model (gemini-3.1-flash-image, 'Nano Banana 2') is scheduled to shut down on 29 October 2026, so if a plugin you use relies on it, expect a switch.

Free vs paid — the detail that catches people out

In the Gemini app, the free tier gives you the older Nano Banana 2. Nano Banana 2.1 needs a paid Google AI plan. In India, Google AI Plus starts at ₹199/month for the first six months, then ₹399/month; Google AI Pro is ₹1,950/month (often ₹975/month for the first year, and free for 18 months for eligible Jio 5G users); Google AI Ultra is ₹6,500/month. AI Plus is the cheapest way for a small seller to get 2.1 in the app. Confirm current pricing on Google's own page before subscribing.

Nano Banana Pro — when quality is worth the premium

Nano Banana Pro (Gemini 3 Pro Image) is Google's top image model. It costs considerably more — about ₹12 per 1K image — but in practice it often produces the most natural, realistic results, particularly in colour and proportion. Use it for a hero shot: the one image that becomes your product page's main photo or your best-performing ad, where quality matters more than cost.

OpenAI GPT Image 2.5 — precision editing

OpenAI's current image models are **gpt-image-2.5-sunburst** (for workflows where editing precision matters most) and **gpt-image-2.5-flare** (fast, everyday generation). Both generate and edit from text and image inputs, and both support the new xhigh and max quality settings. Pricing is token-based: image output is $30 per million tokens, which works out to roughly ₹3 per image at medium quality and about ₹12 at high. On independent arena testing the GPT Image 2.5 family sits at the very top of the image leaderboard, ahead of

Nano Banana 2.1. Reach for it when an edit has to be exact — fixing a label, matching a fabric, changing one detail and leaving the rest untouched.

Black Forest Labs FLUX 3 Image — layouts you control

Released 1 October 2026, FLUX 3 Image is the model for designed images rather than just pretty ones. Its headline feature is bounding boxes: you write the scene, then add a JSON list of boxes — each one **[top, left, bottom, right]** on a 0–1000 grid — to decide exactly where each element goes. It combines up to ten reference images, outputs up to 4K across 15 aspect ratios, and the same boxes let you edit one element (recolour, move, replace, remove) while everything else stays unchanged. This is the tool for a festive banner where the headline, the offer and the product each have to sit in a fixed spot. A lighter open-weight version, FLUX 3 Image Klein, followed on 15 October 2026.

Free and low-cost editors to finish the job

AI images almost always need a last touch — a crop, a colour fix, a size export. You do not need a paid subscription for that. Photoroom and Canva both have India-friendly free tiers and are built for sellers on a phone. PhotoCraft is a free, open-source editor (layers, masks, curves, PSD support) that runs on Windows, Mac and Linux and even in a browser. For most sellers the workflow is: generate in the AI tool, finish in a free editor.

Tool	Best job	Approx. cost / image	Where
Nano Banana 2.1	Volume: lifestyle, seasonal, variants	₹3 (1K) – ₹10 (4K)	Gemini app, AI Studio, Flow
Nano Banana Pro	Hero shot, maximum realism	~ ₹12 (1K)	Google AI plans
GPT Image 2.5	Exact edits, label & fabric match	₹3 – ₹12	OpenAI API / ChatGPT
FLUX 3 Image	Banners & layouts with fixed text spots	Paid API (varies)	bfl.ai, playground & API
Photoroom / Canva	Crop, background, resize, text	Free tier	Phone app / web
PhotoCraft	Layers, masks, colour, PSD	Free (open source)	Desktop & browser

CHAPTER 3

The phone-to-studio method

This is the whole process, start to finish. It takes about thirty minutes for your first product and under ten minutes per product once you have done two. You need a phone with a decent camera, a plain surface, natural light from a window, and one of the tools from Chapter 2.

Step 1 — Shoot the base photo (5 minutes)

Take one clean photo of the product in even natural light, with the whole item in frame and any label or logo facing the camera. Do not stage it, do not clean it up, do not use a ring light — natural light is better. Put it on a plain matte surface (a white sheet, a grey tablecloth, a wall) near a window, ideally in the morning. Shoot from three or four angles. This real photo is your reference image and your honesty anchor: you will keep one of these unedited on every listing.

Do not overthink the base photo. A slightly imperfect original is fine — the model only needs to know the product's true shape, colour and detail.

Step 2 — Build a keep-list (2 minutes)

The keep-list is the short description you paste into every prompt so the product never drifts: material, colour, exact wording on the label, and any defining feature. For example: “a hand-block-printed cotton kurti in indigo blue with small white floral motifs and a wooden button placket.” Keep it identical across every image of that product. Change only the scene, the surface and the light.

Step 3 — Use the five-part prompt formula

Every prompt in this book follows the same skeleton. Learn it and you can write your own:

> **THE FORMULA**
> [exact product + material + colour] + [surface or background] + [light] + [camera / framing] + [quality tag]. Example: “Studio shot of a hand-block-printed indigo cotton kurti. Pure white background. Soft even daylight. Straight-on, full frame. Sharp focus, 4K, professional product photography.”

Step 4 — Generate the standard seven-image set

For each product, build this set. It covers a marketplace listing and a week of social posts:

- **Main image** — pure white background, product alone (the marketplace-safe shot).
- **Extra angles** — two or three more views on the same white background.
- **Lifestyle scene** — the product on a real surface, in the light it would be used in.
- **Scale or in-hand** — one image that answers 'how big is it?'.
- **Infographic** — three short callouts naming the facts buyers ask about.
- **Seasonal version** — the same product dressed for the campaign running now.
- **Ad banner** — a wide crop with your headline, for ads and collection pages.

Step 5 — Iterate by changing one word

If a result is not right, change exactly one thing and regenerate: “white background” to “marble background”, “sharp focus” to “soft focus”, “straight-on” to “three-quarter view”. Do not rewrite the whole prompt and do not chase perfection. If the image is ninety per cent there, use it — a ninety per cent generated shot still beats a bedsheet photo by a wide margin. Save your best prompt for each product so next season you regenerate in one click.

Step 6 — Verify against the real product

Before anything goes live, hold the generated image next to the actual product. Check colour, size, texture, label wording and any pattern. If it flatters the product into something it is not, fix it or drop it. This single habit is what keeps your returns low and your reviews clean.

Step 7 — Finish and export

In a free editor, crop to each platform's size (Chapter 5), correct the colour so the product matches reality, and export. Keep a folder per product with the original photo, the generated set and the prompts you used. Next time you reorder stock, you rebuild the whole set in minutes.

The 90 / 10 rule

Spend ninety per cent of your effort on the base photo and the keep-list, and ten per cent on prompts. A truthful, well-lit base photo with a tight keep-list produces good images almost automatically. A vague base photo produces images that look like a different product.

CHAPTER 4

The prompt library

Over one hundred copy-paste prompts, organised by the job you are doing. Every prompt follows the five-part formula from Chapter 3. Replace the text in square brackets with your product and your keep-list. Where a prompt names a background or a light, swap it for one you have actually seen — the models are better at real rooms than at moods.

How to read these prompts

The words in [square brackets] are yours to fill. Everything else is ready to use. For a product in a new category, take the closest prompt here and change only the product description.

A. White-background main image

Kurti / saree

“Studio shot of [a hand-block-printed cotton kurti in indigo blue with white floral motifs]. Pure white background (RGB 255,255,255). Soft even daylight. Straight-on, product filling the frame. Sharp focus, 4K, professional product photography.”

Jewellery

“Studio shot of [a gold-plated jhumka with pearl drops]. Pure white background. Soft diffused light with a gentle highlight on the metal. Close, centred. Sharp focus, 4K, catalogue photography.”

Handicraft

“Studio shot of [a hand-painted terracotta diya set]. Pure white background. Soft morning light. Slight three-quarter angle. Sharp focus, 4K, clean e-commerce photography.”

Home decor

“Studio shot of [a brass urli bowl]. Pure white background. Soft even light, no harsh shadows. Straight-on, full frame. Sharp focus, 4K, product catalogue photography.”

Food / sweets

“Studio shot of [a box of assorted Indian mithai]. Pure white background. Soft daylight. Straight-on, centred. Sharp focus, 4K, food catalogue photography.”

Beauty / skincare

“Studio shot of [a 100ml amber glass face oil bottle]. Pure white background. Soft diffused studio light. Straight-on. Sharp focus, 4K, premium skincare photography.”

Kids wear

“Studio shot of [a cotton frock in pastel yellow with tiny floral print]. Pure white background. Soft even light. Straight-on, full frame. Sharp focus, 4K, kidswear catalogue photography.”

Footwear
“Studio shot of [a pair of tan kolhapuri chappals]. Pure white background. Soft light with a subtle shadow under the sole. Three-quarter angle. Sharp focus, 4K, footwear catalogue photography.”

Bags
“Studio shot of [a jute tote bag with a block-printed front panel]. Pure white background. Soft even daylight. Straight-on. Sharp focus, 4K, product photography.”

Electronics
“Studio shot of [a matte-black Bluetooth speaker]. Pure white background. Soft studio light with a clean reflection. Straight-on. Sharp focus, 4K, tech product photography.”

Stationery
“Studio shot of [a handmade recycled-paper notebook with a marigold cover]. Pure white background. Soft daylight. Straight-on. Sharp focus, 4K, product photography.”

General fallback
“Studio shot of [your product, exact material and colour]. Pure white background. Soft even light. Straight-on, full frame. Sharp focus, 4K, professional product photography.”

B. Extra angles, scale and in-hand

Three-quarter view
“Same [product], pure white background, three-quarter view showing depth. Soft even light. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Top-down / flat lay
“Same [product] seen from directly above on a plain white surface. Even soft light. Centred. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Detail / close-up
“Close-up of [the block-printed motif and wooden buttons] on [the product]. White background. Soft light. Sharp macro focus, 4K.”

Back view
“Same [product] from the back on pure white background. Soft even light. Straight-on. Sharp focus, 4K.”

In-hand scale
“A hand holding [the product], plain light-grey background, soft daylight. Shows real scale. Sharp focus, 4K, natural photography.”

On-surface scale
“[The product] next to a standard [pencil / coin / ruler] on a plain white surface to show size. Soft light. Straight-on. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Group / set
“[Three colours of the product] arranged in a neat row on pure white background. Even soft light. Straight-on. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Open / in-use
“[The product] shown [open / unfolded / in use], white background. Soft light. Sharp focus, 4K.”

C. Lifestyle scenes — Indian settings

Describe surfaces and light you have actually seen. These are drawn from real Indian homes and shops.

Courtyard morning
“[The product] on a cane chair in a sunlit Indian courtyard, soft morning light, a hint of a tulsi plant in the background. Natural, warm. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Marble & silk
“[The product] on a white marble slab with a fold of raw silk beside it, soft diffused daylight. Elegant. Sharp focus, 4K, lifestyle photography.”

Banana leaf / thali
“[The food product] served on a banana leaf beside a brass thali, warm daylight, simple and fresh. Sharp focus, 4K, food lifestyle photography.”

Bathroom shelf
“[The skincare product] on a clean bathroom shelf with white tiles, soft window light, a sprig of green. Fresh and calm. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Kitchen counter
“[The product] on a wooden kitchen counter with everyday Indian kitchenware softly blurred behind. Warm daylight. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Cotton dhurrie
“[The product] on a handwoven cotton dhurrie in earthy tones, soft daylight. Homely. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Festive table
“[The product] on a table with marigold garlands, diyas and a rangoli edge, warm evening light. Festive but not cluttered. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Bookshop / desk
“[The product] on a wooden desk with a notebook and a cup of chai softly blurred behind. Warm daylight. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Outdoor nature

“[The product] on a mossy stone in a garden after rain, soft overcast light, green leaves around. Natural. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Studio backdrop
“[The product] on a seamless [pastel terracotta] backdrop with a soft gradient, studio light. Clean and modern. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Hands at work
“Hands [stitching / packing] near [the product] on a wooden table, warm side light, artisanal mood. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Windowsill
“[The product] on a windowsill with sheer curtains diffusing the light, soft shadows. Calm. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Cafe table
“[The product] on a cafe table with a coffee cup and a phone softly out of focus, warm light. Lifestyle. Sharp focus, 4K.”

Gift setting
“[The product] presented as a gift beside kraft paper and jute twine, warm light. Thoughtful. Sharp focus, 4K.”

D. Infographics and feature callouts

For an infographic, generate the product clean on white, then add text in a free editor, or ask the model directly. Keep it to three short facts a buyer actually asks about.

Three features
“[The product] on a white background with three short labels and thin leader lines pointing to [material], [size] and [care]. Clean sans-serif text. Sharp, 4K.”

Size chart
“[The product] beside a simple size chart with [measurements] in clean type. White background. Clear and minimal, 4K.”

What's in the box
“[The product] and everything included laid out in a neat row on white, each item labelled. Clean, 4K.”

Care instructions
“[The product] on white with three short care icons and captions [hand wash, dry in shade, iron low]. Minimal, 4K.”

Ingredient / material
“[The product] on white with a simple list of [key materials] in clean type. Editorial, 4K.”

Before / after
“Two panels side by side: [product before] and [product after], thin dividing line, white background, small captions. Clean, 4K.”

Comparison
“Three [product variants] in a row on white, each with a short label underneath. Clean grid, 4K.”

Trust badge row
“[The product] on white with a row of three small trust badges [free shipping, COD, easy returns] in clean line style. 4K.”

E. Festive and seasonal scenes

Diwali
“[The product] on a deep-navy surface with lit diyas, marigold petals and a soft golden bokeh. Warm festive light. Rich, 4K.”

Dhanteras / gold
“[The product] on a maroon velvet surface with gold accents and a small diya, warm light. Luxurious. 4K.”

Karwa Chauth
“[The product] with a decorated karwa, a sieve and mehndi motifs, soft evening light. Traditional. 4K.”

Bhai Dooj
“[The product] arranged as a gift for a sibling with a rakhi-style thread and sweets, warm light. 4K.”

Christmas
“[The product] with pine sprigs, a few warm fairy lights and a subtle red-and-green accent, cosy light. 4K.”

New Year
“[The product] with gold confetti and a champagne-gold backdrop, sparkling light. Celebratory. 4K.”

Republic Day
“[The product] with a subtle tricolour ribbon accent on a clean white surface, bright light. Patriotic but tasteful. 4K.”

Monsoon
“[The product] on a wet stone surface with soft rain bokeh and green leaves, moody light. 4K.”

Summer

“[The product] on a bright cotton backdrop with soft harsh sunlight and a cool drink beside, summery. 4K.”

Wedding season
“[The product] with gold sequins, a rose and soft marigold, elegant evening light. Bridal. 4K.”

Rakhi / gifting
“[The product] as a gift hamper with kraft wrap, twine and a small note, warm light. 4K.”

Harvest / Pongal
“[The product] with fresh sugarcane, turmeric and a clay pot, bright morning light. Earthy. 4K.”

F. Ad creatives and banners (with text)

For banners where the text must sit in an exact spot, use FLUX 3 Image bounding boxes (Chapter 2), or generate a clean image and add the text in a free editor. Keep on-image text to one headline and one offer.

Offer banner
“[The product] on the right of a wide [navy] banner, clean empty space on the left for a headline. Studio light. Sharp, 4K.”

Festive sale banner
“Wide banner, [the product] on a warm festive background with diyas, clear space top-left for text. 4K.”

Product launch
“[The product] centred on a soft gradient background, generous empty space above for a launch headline. Clean, 4K.”

Discount reveal
“[The product] on a bold [gold] background, space at the bottom for a price. High-contrast, 4K.”

Free shipping
“[The product] on a light background with a simple truck icon area at the base for a shipping line. Clean, 4K.”

Combo offer
“[Two products] side by side on white with a '+' between them, space below for a price. Clean, 4K.”

Best-seller
“[The product] on a soft spotlight background, a small badge space top-right. Premium, 4K.”

Story ad (9:16)

“Vertical [the product] on a lifestyle background, clear space at top and bottom for text. Sharp, 4K.”

Reel cover
“Vertical cover: [the product] centred, bold empty band at the top for a title. Eye-catching, 4K.”

Google / Meta ad
“[The product] on a clean bright background with a person [using it] softly behind, space for a headline. 4K.”

G. Social media: carousels, stories, WhatsApp

Carousel cover
“[The product] centred on a bold colour block, clean type space at the bottom. Instagram carousel cover, 4K.”

Carousel slide
“[The product] on white with one short line of text space and a page number. Minimal, 4K.”

Instagram story
“Vertical [the product] on a lifestyle scene with a poll-sticker space at the bottom. 4K.”

WhatsApp catalogue
“Square [the product] on pure white, bright and clear, no text. WhatsApp catalogue, 4K.”

WhatsApp status
“Vertical [the product] with a warm background and space for a short price line. 4K.”

Product card
“[The product] on a soft pastel background with clean space for a name and price. Minimal, 4K.”

Testimonial post
“[The product] on a clean background with a large empty area for a customer quote. Editorial, 4K.”

Behind the scenes
“[The product] being [packed / made] on a wooden table with tools around, warm documentary light. 4K.”

H. Editing and fixing prompts

These start from an existing image (yours or a generated one) and change only what you name.

Remove background

“Keep [the product] exactly as it is, change the background to pure white (RGB 255,255,255). Do not change the product. 4K.”

Clean the surface
“Keep [the product] unchanged, replace the background with [a plain light-grey surface]. Soft even light. 4K.”

Fix lighting
“Keep [the product] identical, brighten and even out the light, remove harsh shadows. 4K.”

Change colour
“Keep [the product]'s shape and material, change its colour to [deep green]. Everything else unchanged. 4K.”

Recolour one part
“Change only [the button placket] to [wood brown]; keep the rest of the [product] exactly the same. 4K.”

Remove an object
“Remove [the stray cable] from the image; fill the space with the [table surface]. Keep [the product] unchanged. 4K.”

Match a reference
“Make [the product]'s [fabric texture] match the reference image exactly; keep the design unchanged. 4K.”

Add a shadow
“Add a soft realistic shadow under [the product] on the white background. Keep the product unchanged. 4K.”

Sharpen
“Keep [the product] identical, make it sharper and remove noise. 4K.”

Add watermark space
“Keep [the product] centred and leave a clean empty corner for a small logo. 4K.”

Upscale to 4K
“Keep [the image] exactly the same but output at 4K, sharp and clean.”

Straighten
“Keep [the product] identical, straighten the image and centre it on white. 4K.”

CHAPTER 5

Marketplace & platform image rules

This is where good images get rejected. Marketplaces do not care which tool made your image — they care that the main image follows their rules. Break them and your listing can be suppressed from search, which is worse than a bad photo because nobody can even find you. Confirm the current rule on your own seller panel before a bulk upload, because these guidelines are updated.

Amazon — the main image is strict

- **Pure white background** (RGB 255, 255, 255). Coloured backgrounds and colour blocks are the most common cause of suppression.
- **The product alone** — no props, no accessories that are not included, no packaging unless it is a genuine product feature.
- **Product fills about 85 per cent** of the frame, shown once, entirely within the frame, not cut off.
- **At least 1,000 pixels** on the longest side so the zoom function turns on (500 x 500 is the minimum to list; 1,000 x 1,000 or more raises listing quality).
- **No text, logos, borders, watermarks or graphics** on the main image.
- **Formats:** JPEG (best), PNG or TIFF.

Use your generated white-background shot as the main image, and put the lifestyle, infographic, scale and in-use images in the secondary slots where they are allowed.

The honest-photo rule still applies

Amazon's own guidance requires images that accurately represent the product. A generated image that changes the product's colour, size or material is a defect, not a shortcut. Keep one real, unedited photo per product in your account even if you do not publish it.

Other platforms — the sizes to know

Platform	Recommended size / rule	Notes
Amazon main image	1:1, pure white RGB 255,255,255, ≥1,000 px	Product ~85% of frame, no text
Shopify	2,048 x 2,048 px square	Good for zoom on themes that support it
Etsy	≥2,000 px on the shortest side	A 2K square render clears it
Instagram feed	1:1 or 4:5	Feed looks best at 1080 px wide
Instagram / Reels story	9:16 vertical	Keep text clear of the top and bottom UI
WhatsApp catalogue	1:1 square	Bright, clear, no text needed

Platform	Recommended size / rule	Notes
Flipkart / Meesho	Follow the same white-background discipline	Check your seller panel for current specs

One practical habit: generate at 2K. On several tools 2K costs the same as 1K, and a 2K square leaves room to crop for every platform above while still clearing the 1,000-pixel zoom threshold.

Disclosure and trust. Shoppers increasingly assume a photo might be generated. Keeping at least one plainly real, unedited photo of every product builds the trust that a wall of perfect images cannot.

CHAPTER 6

The festive calendar & campaign plan

India's festive quarter is not one day; it is a nine-week run of distinct shopping occasions. Search demand for a festival starts climbing weeks before it, so the images should be ready before the interest peaks. Here is the 2026 calendar with the image set to make for each occasion.

Occasion	2026 date	What to make	Publish by
Navratri / Dussehra	11–20 Oct	Festive-wear & puja-item scenes	Now (season running)
Karwa Chauth	29 Oct	Gifting, mehndi, jewellery creatives	~22 Oct
Dhanteras	6 Nov	Gold, silver, home & kitchen hero shots	~30 Oct
Diwali	8 Nov	Gift hampers, decor, festive banners	~1 Nov
Bhai Dooj	10–11 Nov	Gift-for-sibling sets	~3 Nov
Christmas	25 Dec	Cosy gifting & decor scenes	~10 Dec
New Year	1 Jan 2027	Celebration & resolution creatives	~20 Dec
Republic Day	26 Jan 2027	Tricolour-accent creatives	~18 Jan

Two rules that decide the last two weeks. First, announce a **last-order date for delivery before the festival** — festive shoppers treat a sub-two-day delivery as non-negotiable, so state it plainly on the creative. Second, publish a fresh image set for each occasion rather than one 'festive' banner all season; the shopper who ignored your Diwali post may click your Karwa Chauth one.

Build the set once, re-skin it all season

Take each product's base photo once. Then generate a Karwa Chauth, a Diwali and a New Year version from the same keep-list — only the scene changes. At a few rupees an image you can dress your whole catalogue for the season in a single afternoon, and re-run it next year in minutes.

CHAPTER 7

Cost & budget math

A studio shoot in a metro city can run to tens of thousands of rupees a day, before models, props and retouching. That is why most small sellers never shoot. Here is what the AI route actually costs.

Route	Cost	What you get
Studio shoot (metro)	₹25,000–₹50,000+ per day	A limited number of hero shots, booked weeks ahead
AI, Nano Banana 2.1 (1K)	~ ₹3 per image	Lifestyle, seasonal and variant shots at volume
AI, Nano Banana 2.1 (4K)	~ ₹10 per image	High-resolution shots for zoom and banners
AI, GPT Image 2.5	₹3 (medium) – ₹12 (high)	Precision edits and top-tier generation
Finishing (Photoroom / Canva / PhotoCraft)	Free tier	Crop, colour fix, resize, text

A 10-product catalogue. Seven images per product is 70 images. At about ₹3 each on Nano Banana 2.1, that is roughly ₹210 of generation, plus a little for the hero shots you make at higher quality. Add a free editor and the total is a few hundred rupees — against a studio bill that starts in the tens of thousands.

A 50-product catalogue. 350 images. Even budgeting a factor of 1.4 for the images you throw away, that is under 500 generations, still comfortably under a few thousand rupees. If you prefer a subscription over per-image billing, a Google AI Plus plan at ₹399/month (or ₹199 for the first six months) covers most small sellers' monthly volume in the Gemini app.

Where the real cost is

The money is trivial; the time is not. Budget your hours for two things: taking a clean base photo of every product, and checking every generated image against the real item. That is the work that protects your reviews. The generation itself is the fast part.

CHAPTER 8

The 30-day action plan

A week-by-week plan to rebuild your catalogue without stopping your selling. Do it once and you own the system for every season after.

Week 1 — Base photos

- Pick your ten best-selling or highest-margin products.
- Shoot one clean base photo of each in natural light, plus two or three angles.
- Write the keep-list for each product in one line.

Week 2 — Main images and a hero

- Generate the pure-white main image for all ten.
- Pick your best product and make one hero shot on Nano Banana Pro or GPT Image 2.5 at high quality.
- Verify every image against the real product before saving.

Week 3 — The full set

- Generate the lifestyle, scale, infographic and seasonal images for each product.
- Finish and export to each platform's size (Chapter 5).
- Update your marketplace listings, starting with your five best sellers.

Week 4 — Campaigns and measurement

- Build the festive banners and ad creatives for the next occasion in the calendar.
- Post two or three Reels a week using the lifestyle and behind-the-scenes images.
- Watch visit-to-order rate for two weeks before redoing the whole catalogue.

The test that tells you it worked

Put the new images on your five best sellers first and compare the visit-to-order rate for two weeks against the old photos. If it improves, roll the system out to everything. If it does not, the problem was never the photo — and you have saved yourself the work.

CHAPTER 9

Common mistakes & quick reference

The mistakes that cost sales

- **Publishing an image that oversells.** The fastest route to returns and one-star reviews. Verify colour, size and material every time.
- **Text or a coloured background on an Amazon main image.** The most common cause of search suppression.
- **Rewriting the whole prompt when one word is wrong.** Change one thing, regenerate, move on.
- **Chasing a perfect image.** A ninety per cent shot beats a bedsheet photo; ship it.
- **Forgetting the base photo.** Without one clean real photo per product you have no honesty anchor.
- **Generating at 1K when 2K costs the same.** You lose the room to crop for other platforms.
- **One 'festive' banner all season.** Each occasion deserves its own image set.
- **Not checking the current platform rules.** Guidelines change; the seller panel is the source of truth.

Quick reference card

If you need to …	Use …	Remember
Make many lifestyle/seasonal shots	Nano Banana 2.1	~ ₹3/image, up to 14 refs
Get the most realistic hero shot	Nano Banana Pro	~ ₹12/image
Edit one detail exactly	GPT Image 2.5	State what stays unchanged
Place text in an exact spot	FLUX 3 Image	Bounding boxes [top,left,bottom,right]
Crop / colour / resize free	Photoroom, Canva, PhotoCraft	Export per platform
Pass an Amazon main image	White RGB 255, product ~85%, ≥1000 px	No text or props

One-page cheat sheet

THE FIVE-PART FORMULA

[exact product + material + colour] + [surface/background] + [light] + [camera/framing] + [quality tag]. Keep the product description identical across every image of that product; change only the scene.

THE SEVEN-IMAGE SET

Main (white) · Angles · Lifestyle · Scale/in-hand · Infographic · Seasonal · Banner.

THE ONE RULE

AI drafts; you verify. Same colour, same material, same size, same label. Keep one real photo per product.

SOURCES

Verification note

Every figure, model name and price in this edition was checked in October 2026 against the source below. Tool prices and platform rules change often; confirm on the official page before you spend or publish.

- Google — Nano Banana 2.1: Gemini image-generation overview (India) and the Gemini Developer API pricing page (per-image pricing, 1K/2K/4K, reference-image limits).
- Google — subscription pricing in India: Gemini subscriptions page (AI Pro ₹1,950/month) and India pricing summaries (AI Plus ₹199 then ₹399/month; Ultra from ₹6,500/month).
- OpenAI — GPT Image 2.5 Sunburst and Flare: OpenAI API image-generation guide, model pages and the API pricing page (token rates and per-image examples).
- Black Forest Labs — FLUX 3 Image: official model page, FLUX 3 Image overview and layout-prompt documentation (bounding boxes, references, resolutions) and the release notes.
- Amazon — Seller Central product image requirements (pure white RGB 255,255,255; product ~85 per cent; 1,000 px; no text or logos) and Amazon.in listing guidance.
- Platform image sizes — Shopify (2,048 px) and Etsy (2,000 px shortest side) published seller guidance.
- Festive-season demand — Redseer festive forecast (180–185 million online shoppers, ~25 per cent growth); Unicommerce first-week festive data (+31 per cent orders, +85 per cent quick commerce); Google/Ipsos India festive-shopper research (image-led discovery, visual tools).
- Festival dates for 2026 — Dhanteras 6 November, Diwali 8 November, Bhai Dooj 10–11 November, Karwa Chauth 29 October.

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